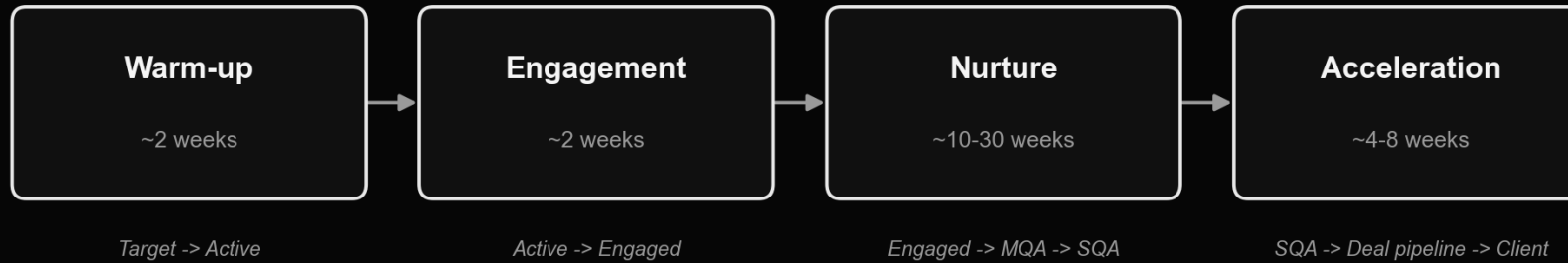


BLACKBELT ON AGENTIC ABM — MEGABRAIN ACADEMY — MODULE 6

6. Designing the ABM Program

Warm-up, engagement, nurture and acceleration — assembling touchpoints into a program, a budget, and a RACI-based execution plan.

6.1 Nine ABM plays, from Target to Renewal



Relationship ladder (personal / social touch):



After the first win, the same touchpoints run again:



The same four timed phases run for every account: warm-up, engagement, nurture, acceleration — then, after the first win, advocacy, up-sell/cross-sell, expansion and renewal reuse the same touchpoints.

6.2

Warm-up & prospecting

Before the first message ever goes out: earn a reason to be noticed. PR, targeted advertising, social selling and offline alternatives all compete for the same ~2-week window.



Warm-up tactics, by lever

PR — speak & appear

Conference panels
Only where $\geq 30\%$ of
attendees are target accounts

PR — thought leadership

Bylines on target pains
Name-check target accounts
in the article, not just us

PR — rankings & awards

Industry-analyst rankings
Contests for target-account
staff, not just prospects

Targeted advertising

LinkedIn Campaign Manager
Programmatic on account
match-lists (ABA)

Social selling

Personal brand + content plan
Grow the right network
Comment before you pitch

Offline alternative

Local press / trade press
Sponsorships near the account's
own industry events

Pick 2-3 of these per account tier, not all six — the point of warm-up is to be recognizable, not to run every channel at once.

Example: a 4-week personal-brand content calendar

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri
Week 1	Business	Expert (long)		Promo	
Week 2		Expert	Business (long)		Friends
Week 3	Expert (long)		Expert		Humor
Week 4	Expert	Business		Expert (long)	

A simple mix that works on LinkedIn: roughly 50% expert/educational, 20% company or business news, and the rest split across personal, humor, and promotional posts.

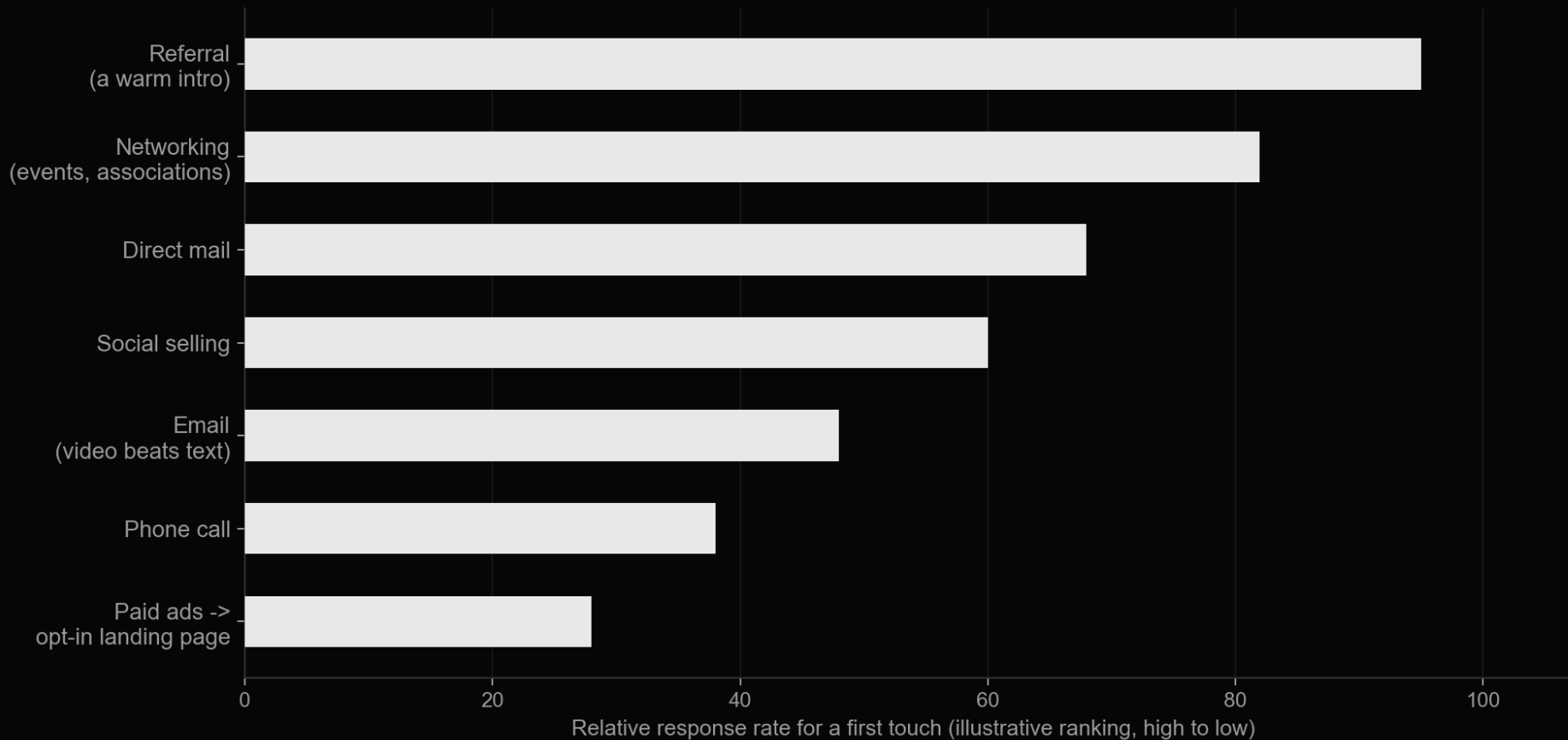
6.3

Engagement — the first conversation

The goal of touch one is a reply, not a close. Reference something real about the person or their company before you ask for anything.



Channel effectiveness for a first touch



A warm referral still beats every paid or automated channel — ask for the introduction before you cold-email.

5 ways to open with real context, not a template

- Their own content: "I read your piece on plant downtime — the point about predictive sensors stuck with me."
- Something they engaged with: "Saw your comment on Maria Chen's post about reshoring — you asked for real examples."
- What they say about themselves: "Your profile says operational efficiency is what gets you out of bed — fair to guess that's still true?"
- Their company, not just them: "Congrats on the new distribution center — that usually means a wave of new hires in ops."
- A shared or niche interest works too, but stay close to their world of work, not yours.

Direct mail & referral outreach

A courier package plus a follow-up call converts to a meeting far better than either alone — every item in the mailer (card, one-pager, testimonial list, CTA) should reinforce the same message.



The follow-up cascade



Five follow-ups over three weeks, each adding new value (a fresh insight, a relevant case, industry news) — never just "following up on my last email."

6.4

Nurture — keeping the account warm

This is the longest phase, roughly 10-30 weeks: the job is to stay useful and visible until the account is ready to talk pipeline, not to force a meeting early.



Nurture tactics landscape

Email sequences & chatbots

Value in every touch,
not just "checking in"
Website chatbot for FAQs

Content hubs

Personalized landing area
per account or per persona

Retargeting

Site visitors + engaged
contacts, always on

Online communities

Private group for the
account tier or persona

Events, on/offline

Webinars, meetups,
roadshows, business
breakfasts

Meeting scheduling

Remove friction from
"let's find time"

Run several of these in parallel and let intent signals (a content-hub visit, a retargeting click, a community reply) tell you when to move an account to acceleration.

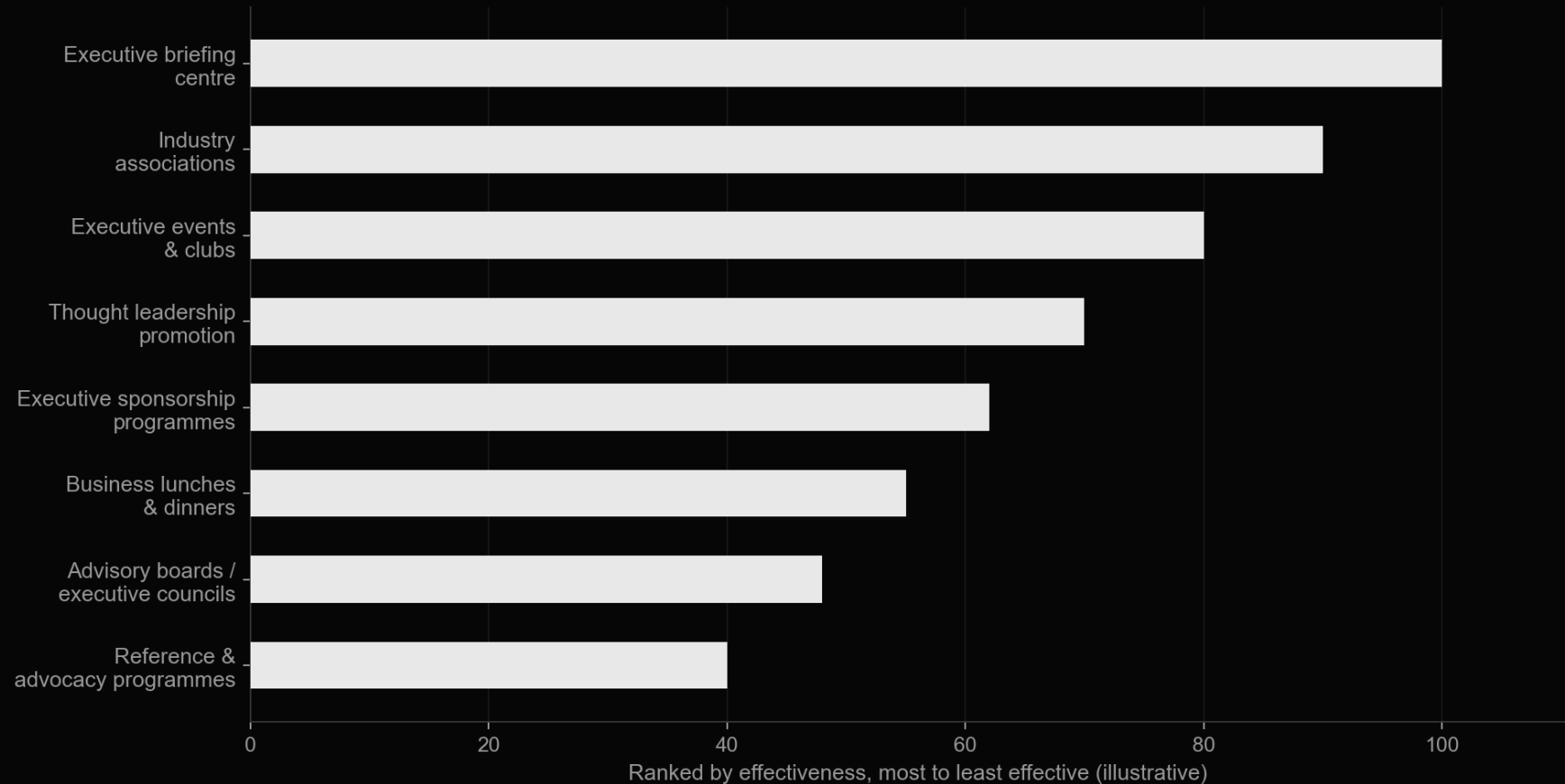
6.5

Acceleration — winning the executive floor

A different playbook for the last mile: relationship-building with the people who actually sign, not more content.



Executive engagement tactics, ranked



Executive briefing centres and industry-association access consistently outperform generic executive events — invest where the relationship is 1:1, not 1:many.

6.6 Assembling the program: budget, timeline, RACI

RACI: agree who does what before you build the plan

R	Responsible Does the work
A	Accountable Owns the outcome, signs off
C	Consulted Weighs in before it happens
I	Informed Told after the decision / action

Every task in the plan below gets exactly one Accountable owner — assign this before the first week starts, not after something slips.

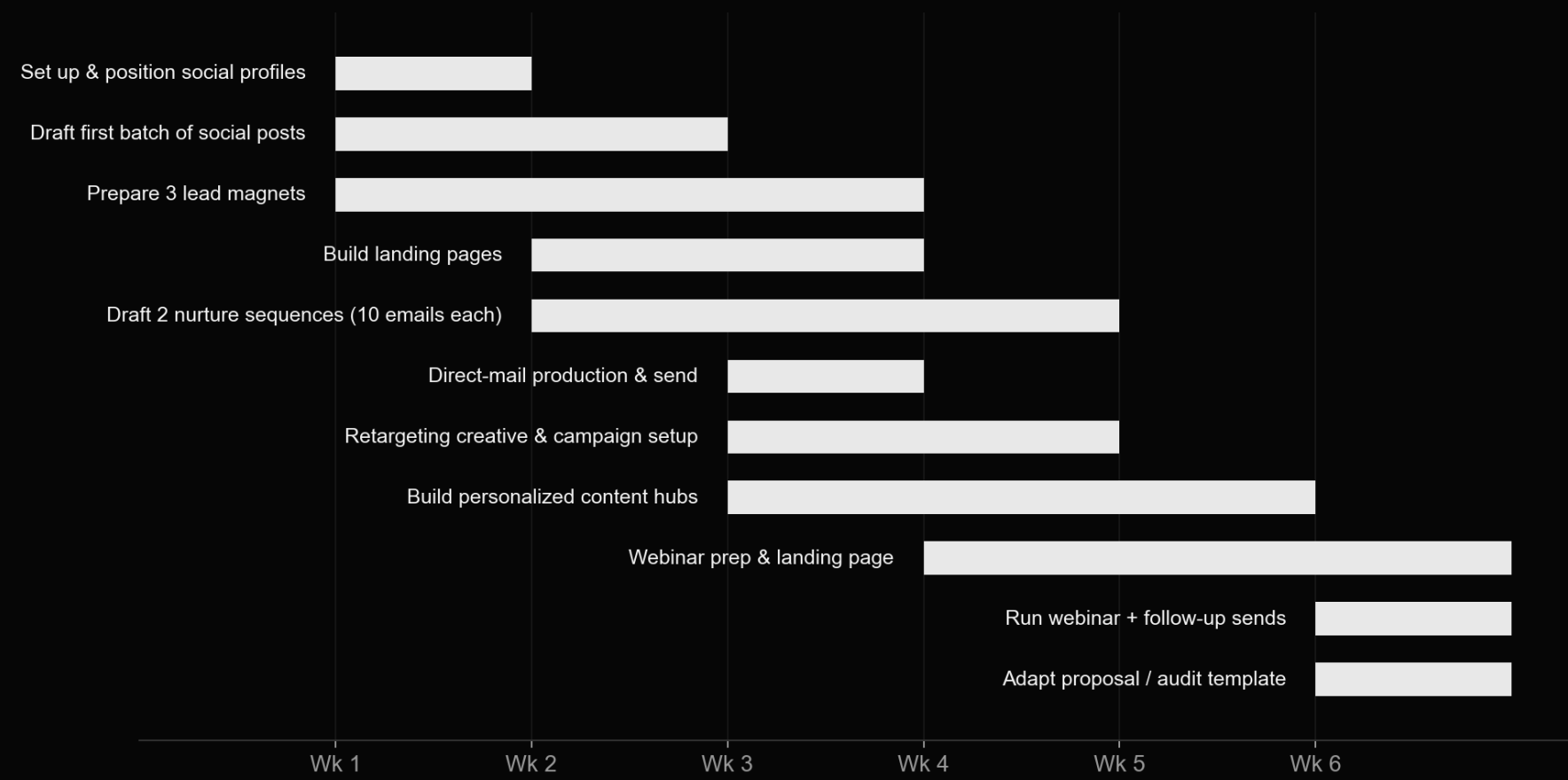
WORKED EXAMPLE

A Fortune 500 industrial client (anonymized)

The in-class capstone example (anonymized here; the original used a real client's actual campaign name, target-account list, task-level hours, and budget). We use it below as a generic "industrial equipment manufacturer" running a plant-efficiency-audit campaign against 20 target accounts, with illustrative, round figures.

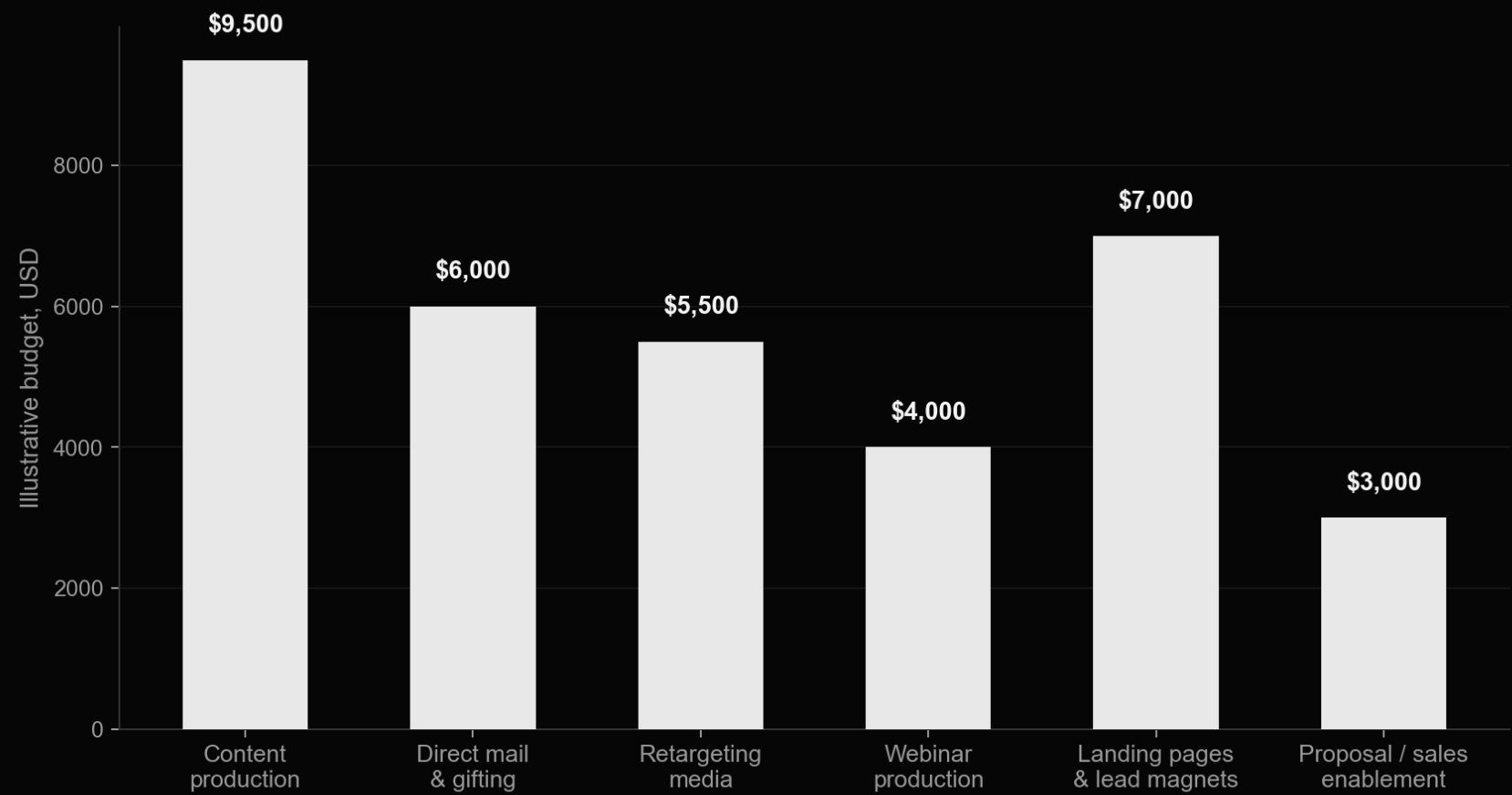


6-week execution timeline



Sixteen tasks, 182 hours total, laid out against the calendar — build this before week 1, not incrementally as you go.

Budget by tactic (illustrative)

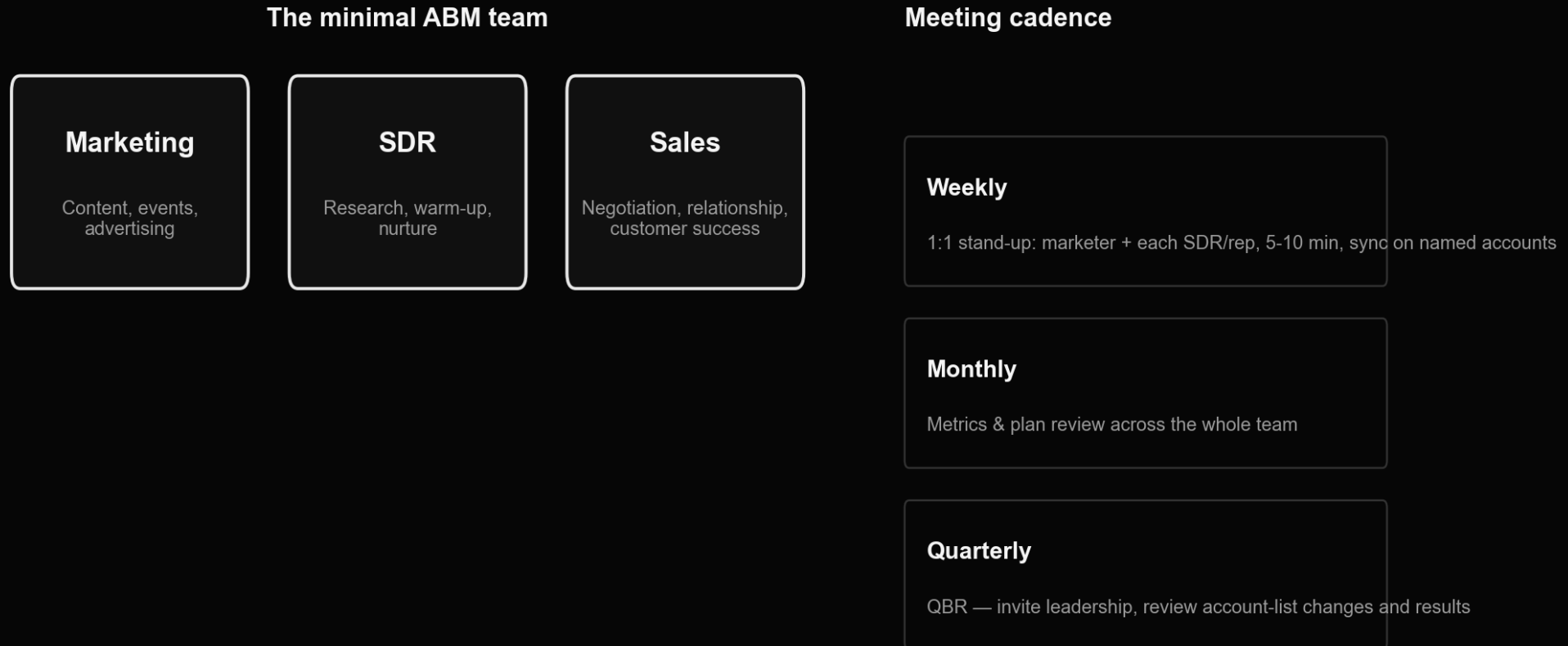


\$9,500 total for this six-week push against 20 accounts — direct mail and retargeting media are the only hard media costs; everything else is team hours.

KPIs for the worked example, now / +1 / +3 / +6 months

Metric	Now	+1 month	+3 months	+6 months
Engaged chief engineers / plant managers	0	8	12	15
Completed plant-efficiency audits	0	1	4	7
Opportunities in pipeline	0	0	3	8
Pipeline value	\$0	\$0	\$150,000	\$400,000
Stakeholder relationship score (avg. change)	0	+0.5	+1.5	+2.5

The minimal ABM team & its meeting cadence



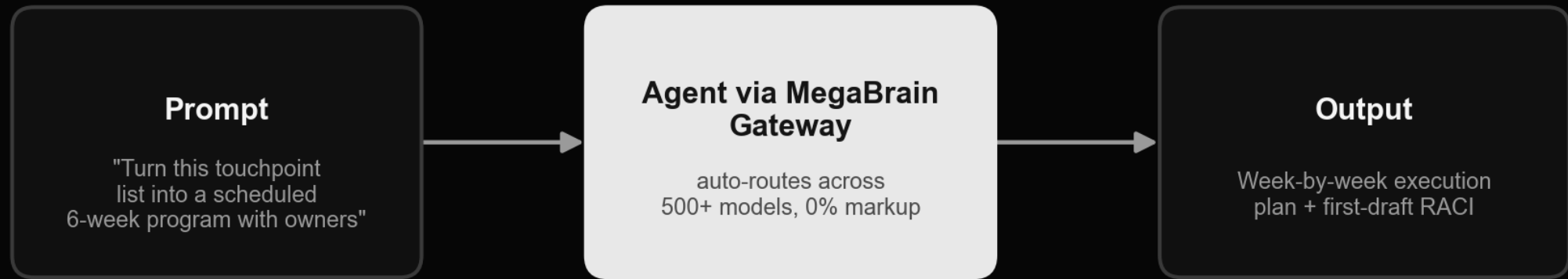
Three roles is the floor, not the ceiling — Marketing, SDR and Sales each own a different stretch of the same account journey, and the cadence is what keeps them from drifting apart.

Keys to sales-and-marketing alignment

- Start with one joint kickoff meeting — explain why ABM changes how the two teams already work together
- Agree shared definitions in writing: what counts as a qualified account, an engaged contact, a sales-ready opportunity
- Tie part of marketing's bonus to pipeline created and won, not just leads delivered
- Include marketing in forecasting calls — visibility into the number raises marketing's accountability for it
- Run a regular joint account-review meeting (some teams call these "quarterback meetings") with clear ground rules
- Agree an SLA for research quality, response time, and account attention — and get executive sponsorship before rollout

6.8 Agentic ABM in practice

MegaBrain: an agent workflow for this module



Paste in your touchpoint list and target-account count; the agent proposes a scheduled program with hours, owners, and a first-draft RACI — a starting point to edit, not a finished plan.

Other agent & automation tools for program execution

monday.com — the shared touchpoint calendar and RACI board the whole team edits together. Salesloft (now positioned as a "revenue workflow platform" after Clari's 2025 acquisition) — sequences and executes the multi-channel cadence per account. Calendly — removes the back-and-forth from booking executive briefings, demos, and QBRs. Make — wires signals across systems, e.g. auto-creating a CRM task and a Slack alert the moment a target account revisits a content hub.



Exercises

Homework 1 — draft your own ABM program

- Pick one account tier from your Module 2 shortlist (or a single 1:1 account) and pick the four phases: warm-up, engagement, nurture, acceleration
- For each phase, select 2-3 tactics from this module's tactics grids — write down which ones and why they fit this account tier
- List every touchpoint in sequence with a rough week number, using the 6-week timeline in this module as a template
- Estimate hours per task and assign one Accountable owner to each — use the RACI template, not just a to-do list
- Sanity-check the total hours against who you actually have available before you commit to the calendar

Homework 2 — fill in the budget & RACI template

- Open [program-budget-raci-template.xlsx](#) (linked below) and clear every example value on the Budget & RACI sheet
- Enter your own program's tasks, hours, and illustrative or real budget figures, one row per task
- Assign R/A/C/I using your own team's role labels — resist leaving any task without exactly one Accountable owner
- Fill in the Program Setup sheet: target-account count, campaign name, goal, and KPIs
- Log at least 3 real open questions or blockers on the Action Items sheet before you call the plan final

Homework 3 — design your internal rollout plan

- Decide which of the two rollout patterns from this module fits your org: a full workshop-and-pilot-team launch, or a lightweight 3-account pilot with one enthusiastic colleague
- If piloting: pick exactly 3 target accounts, personalize the touchpoints for their real stakeholders, and set a 90-day review date
- Book the recurring meetings now, not later: a weekly stand-up, a monthly metrics review, and a quarterly business review with leadership invited
- Write one paragraph on what "good" looks like after 90 days — this becomes the yardstick for your Homework 4 test run

Homework 4 — run one week of the program through MegaBrain

- Using the MegaBrain account you set up in Module 1, feed your Homework 1 touchpoint list into an agent prompt asking for a scheduled program with owners
- Compare the agent's draft plan against your own manual draft — note every place they disagree
- Pick the single biggest disagreement and resolve it by hand — this is the judgment call an agent can't make for you
- Keep both drafts; you'll want the comparison the first time a stakeholder asks "why does the plan look like this?"